Do in-store display weeks raise sales, and are they worth it?

Promotion uplift on 84.51°'s *The Complete Journey* 2.0: 2,469 households, one year, 112 stores with promotion data. DuckDB, 31.9M-row product × store × week table.

+30% to +55%

Display weeks, against stores without the display that week. Includes their deeper price cuts (20% loyalty discount vs 12%). A range: sales were already +21% the week before.

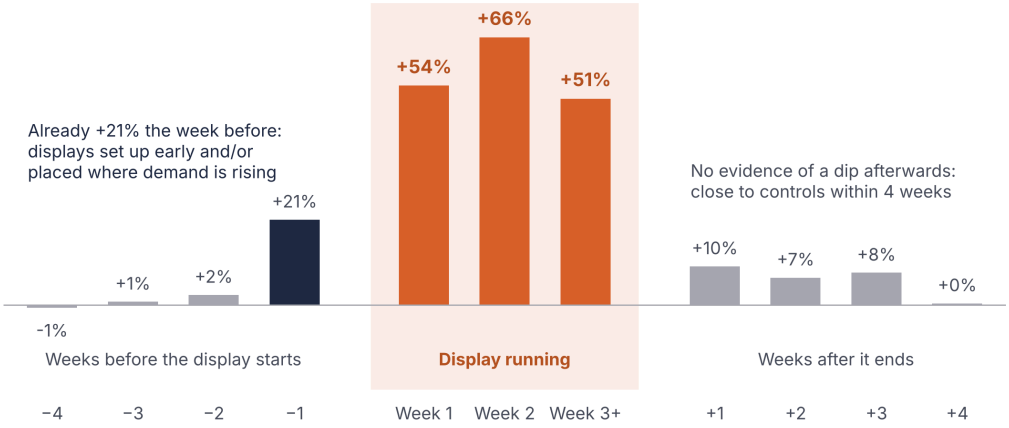
About double

Mailer feature, as a package: +90% to +119% by two methods, but mailer weeks also carry 34–36% loyalty discounts.

No evidence of a dip

Sales stay at or above control stores for 4 weeks after a display ends, and the rest of the category does not fall.

Sales against control stores, isolated display runs (method B)



RECOMMENDATION

1. **Use displays selectively.** Display weeks lift sales but carry deeper discounts (20% of shelf value vs 12% normally). Under a 20–30% margin assumption, the extra sales would not cover the extra discount. Under a 40% assumption, the extra margin covers a display only if a display-week costs less than about 7% of the product's normal weekly sales.
2. **Start where even the low end of the range is large:** packaged candy, cookies, frozen pizza, frozen meals. In eight categories (e.g. condiments, soup, beer, powdered drinks) the range includes zero: no evidence that displays pay off there.
3. **Test before scaling.** Assign displays to stores at random for a few categories to remove the week-before jump, and test the display and the price cut separately.

Category, ranked by low end of range	Runs	90% range of uplift	Extra panel sales, all runs	Break-even at 40% margin*
Candy - Packaged	1,469	+121% to +215%	$346	+39%
Cookies/Cones	864	+76% to +150%	$152	+22%
Frozen Pizza	742	+74% to +174%	$188	+9%
Frzn Meat/Meat Dinners	644	+61% to +174%	$105	+6%
... lowest four of 25 categories with ≥ 300 runs				
Beers/Ales	504	-12% to +54%	$93	+7%
Convenient Brkfst/Whlsm Snacks	400	-14% to +70%	$23	+6%
Fruit - Shelf Stable	337	-22% to +51%	$6	-4%
Pwdr/Crystl Drnk Mx	647	-22% to +43%	$8	+7%

LIMITS

- **Coverage:** 7.7% of display runs qualify (30,918 of 402,452) and 64% of those last one week, so the result applies to isolated, mostly one-week displays.
- **Not an experiment:** displays start where sales are already rising, so the upper bound treats the week-before jump as display effect and the lower bound treats it as targeting. A daily check suggests part of it is early set-up.
- **Bundled price cuts:** display and mailer weeks both carry deeper loyalty discounts, so neither effect can be separated from its price cut.
- **No cost data:** break-even uses 20/30/40% margin scenarios; no profit is claimed. *Most a display-week can cost, as % of normal weekly sales, using the upper bound. Sales are from a 2,469-household panel, not whole stores. One US grocer, one year; results are associations.

Data: 84.51° Complete Journey 2.0, via the R package `completejourney` (CC0) and its Python port; raw data not redistributed. Code, checks and notebook: run_all.py rebuilds everything.